

Will Preparation Packet

A practical 7-page organizer for collecting information before you create or update estate planning documents.

Important: this packet is not a legal document, will, trust, power of attorney, health directive, or substitute for advice from a licensed professional. State rules vary. Use this to organize your information and questions.

How to use this packet

- [] Fill in what you know. Leave blanks for items you need to research.
- [] Do not write passwords directly in this packet. Instead, note where secure access instructions are stored.
- [] Bring the completed packet to a licensed estate planning attorney, reputable online service, or trusted professional review.
- [] Update this packet after major life changes such as marriage, divorce, birth or adoption, home purchase, business changes, or relocation.

Planning area	Notes
Primary goal	
Who this plan is for	
Important deadline or life event	
Questions for a professional	

1. Personal and Family Information

Use this page to gather names and relationship details. Exact legal names can matter when creating documents.

Item	Details
Full legal name	
Other names used	
Address	
Phone and email	
Spouse or partner	
Children or dependents	
Pets to plan for	
Close family contacts	

Questions to resolve

- ☐ Who should be notified first in an emergency?
- ☐ Are there family circumstances that need special care or professional advice?
- ☐ Are any dependents minors, disabled, or financially vulnerable?

2. Assets and Accounts Inventory

List what exists and where records can be found. This worksheet is for organization, not a valuation guarantee.

Category	What to list
Real estate	Address, ownership type, mortgage/lender notes
Vehicles and titled property	VIN/title location, loan notes
Bank accounts	Institution names and account type, not full account numbers if stored insecurely
Investments and retirement	Institution, account type, beneficiary review needed?
Life insurance	Company, policy location, beneficiary review needed?
Business interests	Entity name, operating documents, advisor contact
Personal property	Items with financial or sentimental importance

Potential professional review triggers

- ☐ Out-of-state property
- ☐ Business ownership
- ☐ Blended family
- ☐ Special needs beneficiary
- ☐ Large debts or tax questions
- ☐ Disagreements likely among heirs

3. People and Roles

Think through who could serve in important roles. Ask permission before naming someone in a formal document.

Role	Preferred person and backup
Executor / personal representative	
Backup executor	
Guardian for minor children, if applicable	
Backup guardian	
Financial power of attorney candidate	
Health care decision-maker candidate	
Trusted document contact	

- ☐ Does this person live nearby or have practical ability to help?
- ☐ Is there a conflict of interest or family tension?
- ☐ Would this person understand the responsibility?

4. Beneficiaries and Instructions

Beneficiary designations on some accounts may pass outside a will. This page helps you flag what needs review with a qualified professional or account provider.

Item	Notes
Primary beneficiaries	
Backup beneficiaries	
Accounts with beneficiary forms	
People or organizations to consider	
Specific gifts or sentimental items	
People intentionally not included - discuss with professional	
Charitable wishes	

- ☐ Review retirement, life insurance, transfer-on-death, and payable-on-death forms.
- ☐ Check whether beneficiaries are current after major life changes.
- ☐ Ask about minor beneficiaries before naming them directly.

5. Documents and Storage

Record what documents already exist and where originals are stored. Avoid hiding original documents where no one can access them.

Document	Location / status
Existing will	
Trust documents	
Power of attorney	
Health care directive or living will	
Property deeds and titles	
Insurance policies	
Marriage/divorce/adoption records	
Military, immigration, or other key records	

- ☐ Tell a trusted person where originals are kept.
- ☐ Do not assume a scanned copy has the same effect as an original.
- ☐ Review storage choices with a professional if needed.

6. Digital Assets and Practical Access

Do not write passwords here. Use this page to document categories and safe storage locations.

Category	Notes / safe location
Password manager or secure access plan	
Primary email accounts	
Financial logins	
Cloud storage and photo libraries	
Social media accounts	
Subscriptions and recurring bills	
Crypto or digital wallet notes - professional help strongly recommended	
Device passcodes location or access plan	

- ☐ Avoid sharing passwords casually.
- ☐ Record where secure instructions are kept.
- ☐ Ask a professional about lawful digital asset access.

7. Next-Step Decision Page

Use this page to decide what to do next after your information is organized.

Option	When it may be worth considering
Licensed estate planning attorney	Complex family, assets, business, tax, special needs, real estate, or conflict concerns
Reputable online will service	Simple planning needs and comfort using guided software
Hybrid review service	Online convenience plus professional review
DIY form research	Only for low-risk education and with careful state-rule review

My next action

Action	Date / owner / notes
Schedule a consultation or compare providers	
Update beneficiary forms	
Gather missing documents	
Review packet after life changes	

Reminder: This packet is for organization only. Do not rely on it as legal, tax, financial, medical, or safety advice.